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1873

Mr Pratt
Dr Wood

No 46

United States Consulate

Amoy, July 11th 1874

Mr J. J. Henderson, Consul.
To the Department of State.

DEPARTMENT OF STATE
SEP 11 1874

Subject

Japanese in Formosa

Contents

Letter to Hon S. Wells Williams. Letter to Lieut Commdr. Cassel. Notification accompanying same and reply from Lt Commdr. Cassel

No 40. United States Consulate
Amoy, July 11th 1874

Hon J. C. B. Davis
Asst Secretary of State.
Washington D.C.

Sir,

I have the honor to enclose copy of dispatch with its inclosures which I recently forwarded to the United States Charge d'affaires at Peking.

I am Sir,
Your obedient servt
J. V. Thurburn
U.S. Consul.

Inclosures.

1. Letter to Hon S. Wells Williams
2. " " Lt Commander Douglas Cassel
3. Notification accompany same.
4. Reply from Lt Commdr Cassel.

(Copy)

No. 6. United States Consulate
Amoy July 8th 1874

Hon. S. Wells Williams
U. S. Chargé d'Affaires
Peking.

Sir:

I have the honor to inform you that pursuant to instructions contained in your dispatch of June 5th ult., preceded by a telegram from Mr. Seward dated June 15th ult., I have caused Messrs. Cassel and Wassam each to be personally served with a copy of the enclosed notification and letter.

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The service was made at Liangkiau on June 30th 1874.

The officer making the service reports Mr. Cassel as saying that "he had a few days before received a copy of the same notification from Mr. Thompson, Consular agent at Takao, but that he

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cared nothing for it, and just tore it up; that one hundred men could not arrest him and take him away from the Japanese Camp. now; and other things equally im-pendent.

I enclose copy of a letter he sent me by officer Hollander, I was yesterday shown one Captain Kautz received from him, (Cassel) through the same hands, wherein he claims for himself and Wassam the credit of having preserved the peace between the Chinese and Japanese. Thinks he is not violating any law so long as they remain so, and plainly discloses an intention to disregard your warning. Says he recently dictated the terms of an arrange-ment (which has been agreed to by the Chinese Imperial Commissioner who recently visited Siang Kiang) for the peaceable adjustment of the difficulty, whereby China guarantees protection to all foreigners in Formosa hereafter; pays the expenses of the Japanese

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Japanese expedition, amounting to about 1,200,000. dollars, and the Japanese at once withdraw.

Since it is to me doubtful whether the Government at Peking will ratify such an arrangement, I consider the trouble not so near-ly at an end as Mr. Cassel seems to suppose.

He thinks the most critical moment is just at hand, and that it would ruin the cause if he and Wassam should withdraw now.

I shall observe and report movements, and await further instructions

I am,

Sir,

Your obedient servant

(Signed) J. J. Henderson

U.S. Consul

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Copy

№ 25. United States Consulate
Amoy, June 16th 1874

Lieutenant Commander Douglas Cassel U.S.N.
Liangkiau

Sir,

I am advised by Hon S. Wells Williams United States Chargé d'affaires at Peking that the Japanese armed expedition against Formosa is without the sanction of the Chinese Government, and am instructed by him to notify and warn you and all other citizens of the United States to at once withdraw from that enterprise under penalty of arrest and trial for violation of the laws of neutrality, and you are hereby so notified and warned.

I am, Sir,
Your obedient servant
(signed) J. J. Henderson
U. S. Consul.

Copy of the above to Coll Wassam.

United States Consulate Amoy and the Dependencies thereof.

JUNE 16th. 1874.

NOTIFICATION.

All Citizens of the UNITED STATES are hereby notified and warned to at once withdraw from the Japanese armed expedition now operating in the island of FORMOSA, and hereafter to avoid any connection with that enterprise, under penalty of arrest and trial for violation of the laws of neutrality.

J. J. HENDERSON,

United States Consul.

By instruction from Hon. S. Wells Williams,

U. S. Chargé d'Affaires Peking.

Copy

Camp in the Liang Kau valley
30th of June 1874

My dear Mr Henderson.

I have written a note to Capt. Hautz which he will read to you and which will I believe satisfy you of how much cause for alarm the Chinese have so far as this expedition is concerned and also of how needless Mr. Williams' action is in regard to the presence of Americans with the Japanese forces

Suffice it to say that I am firmly convinced that in the course of the next month the whole matter will be amicably arranged and to the honor of both sides and I may add, in parenthesis and very modestly, to the credit of the Americans who are engaged.

I have taken the liberty of enclosing herewith a cover addressed to the Japanese Consul at Amoy which I beg you will forward to him.

Believe that I am faithfully yours
signed / Douglas Cassel.